Ambassador Pickring. I understand very clearly the point you are making. The only thing I can say is they do have elections in Afghanistan. And in the end it will be up to Afghans to decide who it is that they want to see running their country. We know and understand President Karzai would like to run again. And we certainly all wish him well. I understand there are others who may seek that office too and who may one way or another in the eyes of Afghans be better equipped to deal with it. We will just have to wait and see how that particular part of the process goes.

Having been involved in the United States Government for a long period of time one of the things we do least well is to pick other people's leaders for them.

Mr. Costa. Obviously. We do not have a good track record there.

General Jones, I was struck when we were there in March, the balance of soft power versus our hard power. And going up to Kunar Province watching a platoon fighting the Taliban, at the same time building a road and building bridges is truly inspiring.

But the primary mission of our troops is not to build roads and bridges. How do we strike a balance that allows us to build the schools and the water systems without putting that burden on our military?

General Jones. Well, I think just to piggyback a little bit on *Ambassador Pickring*'s point is that we have—there are a lot of contradictions in that country, we have the PRT system and every country has its own PRT.

Mr. Costa. Right.

General Jones. And different standards. We have to understand that there is not a one-size-fits-all category here. Somebody has to do it. The ultimate solution is in fact in my view civil reform. The disappointment that the electorate might feel in Afghanistan after these really fantastic stories of the vote in 2004 meant that the Afghan people got it; they really understood what the promise was. And they will now express their opinions at the polls whether those expectations are realized, and I suspect that in many parts of the country they will say they were not.

But clearly wherever the, whatever part of Afghanistan one finds a problem you have to apply the solution that is most available to you. And sometimes, unfortunately,——

Mr. Costa. It is our troops.

General Jones [continuing]. It is our troops.

Mr. Costa. Final question, General. We were talking about the areas in the western area and having been up to the Khyber Pass and looking at that, clearly Pakistan's focus has been with India and a traditional armed forces. We have been trying to help them, I know, with their counterinsurgency efforts with the new general in command. I think Mr. Vickers has been there. What progress are we making there? Are we giving them the tools to deal with that?

General Jones. Well, it has been a while since I have been up there. But in my recent conversations with people who know about these things say that we have in the eastern part of the country been quite successful in our counterintelligence, I mean counterinsurgency operations. We need to transfer some of that expertise into the south. And I think that between those two areas we really have the vulnerabilities from a military standpoint of the country because of the proximity to the border regions. So——

Chairman Berman. General, I am sorry.

General Jones. Okay.

Chairman Berman. The time has expired. Hate to do that to you but thank you.

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